F5 Daily Briefing – Friday, November 06 – Sunday, November 08, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

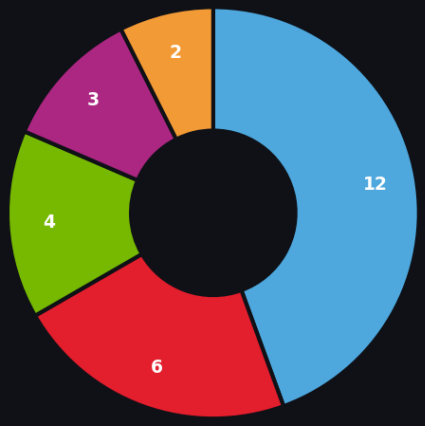
22	27	13	5
COMPETITORS TRACKED	ANNOUNCEMENTS	ACTIVE	ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



- AWS (5)
- Cloudflare (4)
- Palo Alto Networks (3)
- Cisco (3)
- Zscaler (3)
- Check Point Software (2)
- Lasso Security (1)
- Pillar Security (1)
- Barracuda Networks (1)
- Imperva (Thales) (1)
- Fastly (1)
- Citrix (NetScaler) (1)
- Arista Networks (1)

Announcements by Category



- Platforms (12)
- AI Security (6)
- AI Data Delivery (4)
- Application Security (3)
- Application Delivery (ADCs) (2)

ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (27)

Research · Lasso Security · 2026-11-08

Lasso Research: AI Supply Chain Risk – Guardrails and Agent Harnesses Can Miss Familiar Attacks

Lasso published adversarial testing showing trusted AI stack components can fail even when they look secure. It reached a 36% bypass rate against Perplexity's BrowseSafe prompt-injection detector using basic encodings and 42.2% against ServiceNow's AprielGuard. With the same model, attack success was 1% in one agent harness and 24.4% in another. Lasso says teams should test the full assembled stack and enforce policy at runtime. This backs F5's case for continuous AI Red Team testing paired with F5 AI Guardrails, but expect Lasso to use the data against rival guardrails.

https://www.lasso.security/blog/ai-supply-chain-risk-what-it-is-where-it-hides-and-how-to-validate-every-component

Product Update · Imperva (Thales) · 2026-11-08

Imperva Cloud Application Security November 8 Release: New Delhi PoP, Security AI Assistant GA, Elastic WAF Fix, Google Cloud Terraform

Thales Imperva's November 8 Cloud Application Security release adds a New Delhi point of presence, automatic cleanup of inactive auto-discovered Cloud WAF domains, and a critical Elastic WAF 2.2.2 fix for the Node2Shell CVE-2026-111497. It also adds Terraform support for Imperva for Google Cloud and an Advanced Bot Protection iOS SDK update. The opt-in Imperva Security AI Assistant is now generally available on a phased rollout. Why it matters to F5: Imperva is adding AI-assisted operations and multicloud WAAP coverage that compete directly with F5 Distributed Cloud WAAP.

https://docs-cybersec.thalesgroup.com/bundle/cloud-application-security/page/release-notes/2026-11-08.htm

Event Pillar Security 2026-11-06

Pillar Security at OWASP Global AppSec USA: 'Open Source Sleeper Agents' Chat-Template Backdoor Research

On Nov 6 in San Francisco, Pillar researchers Ariel Fogel and Omer Hofman showed how a few lines added to a GGUF/open-weight model's chat template can plant backdoors. In the demo, a poisoned template made a coding agent install attacker-controlled packages, with no change to model weights or data. Pillar is pairing the talk with an open-source chat-template scanner for model intake. This puts Pillar at the front of the AI supply-chain and model-intake conversation, an area where F5 AI Red Team and AI Guardrails should show equal depth.

https://www.pillar.security/events-webinars

Security Advisory Barracuda Networks 2026-11-06

Researchers Chain Two Barracuda Email Security Gateway Flaws to Get Root Access Without Logging In

watchTowr researchers showed that two Barracuda flaws can be chained on the Email Security Gateway to get root without logging in. CVE-2026-116606 (CVSS 9.3) is an authorization bypass that lets an attacker restore a crafted backup. CVE-2026-111560 (CVSS 8.6) is a command injection bug. The injection flaw also affects Barracuda WAF, Load Balancer ADC, WAF Control Center, Message Archiver and Web Security Gateway. Patches are out. Barracuda advises limiting access to admin interfaces. Why it matters to F5: the advisory spans Barracuda's WAF and ADC lines, so security-appliance hygiene is a live talking point with Barracuda WAF/ADC customers.

https://thehackernews.com/2026/11/experts-demonstrate-barracuda-email.html

Acquisition Palo Alto Networks 2026-11-06

Palo Alto Networks Reportedly Negotiating to Buy Israeli AI Security Startups Clutch and Beacon

Reports say Palo Alto Networks is negotiating to buy two Israeli startups, Clutch Security and Beacon Security. The Clutch deal is reported at about $500M in cash plus milestone payments. Clutch secures the non-human identities and credentials that AI agents use, which would add to Palo Alto's CyberArk identity portfolio. Neither company has confirmed a deal. Why it matters to F5: Palo Alto keeps buying its way into agentic AI security. F5 teams should be ready to explain how F5 AI Guardrails and AI gateway controls cover agent traffic without a fragmented, acquisition-built stack.

https://www.calcalistech.com/ctechnews/article/4sjcl3ooj

Product Launch Palo Alto Networks 2026-11-06

Multicloud Security Fabric for Software Firewalls Powered by PAN-OS 12.1 Orion

Palo Alto Networks introduced a Multicloud Security Fabric for its Software Firewalls. It applies one security posture across AWS, Azure and Google Cloud, with automated asset discovery, continuous risk assessment, Microperimeters to contain lateral threats, and a Hyperscale Security Fabric that scales on demand. It covers VMs, containers and AI models. Why it matters to F5: Palo Alto is pitching consistent multicloud policy and automated deployment, which is core F5 Distributed Cloud and multicloud app delivery and security ground. Cloud alliances and sellers should stress F5's app-layer and API protection across clouds.

https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/network-security/automated-multicloud-security-for-software-firewalls/

Product Update Palo Alto Networks 2026-11-06

Cortex Advanced Email Security Adds Unified Threat Inbox, AI Summaries and Evasion Analysis

Palo Alto Networks updated Cortex Advanced Email Security with a Threat Inbox workbench. It combines automated detections with phishing reports from employees, and adds AI-generated summaries and evasion analysis to cut triage time and duplicate work. Why it matters to F5: this is another sign that Cortex is growing into a broad, AI-assisted SOC platform. F5 product marketing should keep the message that F5 is the best-of-breed app and API layer that feeds these platforms, not a competitor to them.

https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/security-operations/transforming-email-incident-response-unifying-alert-triage-ai-summaries-and-evasion-analysis-with-cortex-advanced-email-security/

Customer Win Cisco 2026-11-06

Cisco Deepens Gillette Stadium Partnership as Official Enterprise Networking and Wi-Fi Partner

Cisco is now the Official Enterprise Networking, Wi-Fi and Wi-Fi Analytics Partner for the Kraft Group, the New England Patriots and Gillette Stadium, up from Official Technology Partner. The deal covers AI-ready Wi-Fi 7 and secure, connected venue infrastructure, with NWN as the integrator. Why it matters to F5: Cisco uses big-name venue wins to sell its full-stack platform. Field and marketing teams should be ready with F5 customer proof points for app delivery and security in high-traffic, fan-facing digital experiences.

https://blogs.cisco.com/industries/building-a-future-ready-infrastructure-at-gillette-stadium

Customer Win Cisco 2026-11-06

How Cisco Built an Enterprise AI Factory: Triple GPU Utilization, 6x Compute in Same Footprint

Cisco IT described the full-stack, multi-tenant AI factory it built for its own business. Cisco says average GPU utilization rose from about 15% to about 50%, compute grew sixfold to more than 1,568 GPUs in the same footprint, and about 80% of steady-state inference runs on-premises. It reports 99.99%+ availability, with runtime guardrails from Cisco AI Defense and Hypershield. Why it matters to F5: GPU utilization and inference efficiency are central to F5's AI data delivery story. Product marketing should answer with F5 proof points on AI traffic management and GPU load balancing, built with NVIDIA.

https://blogs.cisco.com/cisco-on-cisco/how-cisco-built-an-enterprise-ai-factory

Product Update Cisco 2026-11-06

Splunk Ships New Cisco AI Defense Detections and Threat Operations Dashboard

Splunk's October security content recap was published November 6. It adds Cisco AI Defense detections for allowed sensitive prompts and responses and for repeated high-risk activity, a new 'Abuse of GenAI Systems and Applications' analytic story, and an alpha AI Defense Threat Operations Dashboard. Why it matters to F5: Cisco is tying AI runtime security telemetry into Splunk SOC workflows. Product and PMM teams should check that F5 AI Guardrails telemetry integrates with SIEMs, Splunk included, so F5 stays in the SOC conversation.

https://www.splunk.com/en_us/blog/security/splunk-security-content-for-threat-detection-response-october-recap.html

Product Update Zscaler 2026-11-06

Zscaler Maps Zero Trust Exchange Controls to Australia's APRA CPS 230 and CPS 234, Plus APRA AI Expectations

Zscaler released control-mapping guides showing how the Zero Trust Exchange helps Australian banks meet APRA CPS 234 (ICT risk) and CPS 230 (operational resilience). The guides map inline inspection, logging, Business Continuity Cloud, Private Service Edge and ZDX to specific requirements. A third guide covers APRA's April 2026 AI supervisory expectations. Why it matters to F5: Zscaler is pitching its platform on regulatory compliance in financial services. F5 sellers and PMM should have matching APRA and AI-governance mappings for F5 Distributed Cloud and AI Guardrails in ANZ banking deals.

https://insidecybersec.com/zscaler-maps-zero-trust-controls-to-apra-cps-230-and-cps-234/

Research Zscaler 2026-11-06

Zscaler CXO Insights: Critical Vulnerabilities Are Now Outrunning Enterprise Response

A Zscaler board-level post argues that AI-assisted vulnerability discovery and huge patch volumes are outpacing enterprise remediation. It cites OT attacks on industrial refrigeration and recommends Zero Trust to hide internet-facing apps and shrink the attack surface. Why it matters to F5: Zscaler is using 'patching can't keep up' to argue for replacing exposed app infrastructure. F5 can answer with WAF/WAAP virtual patching and API protection, which act as compensating controls without re-architecting.

https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/cxo-insights/critical-vulnerabilities-are-now-outrunning-enterprise-response

Event Zscaler 2026-11-06

Zscaler's Nathan Howe Pushes Zero Trust Everywhere for OT via Zscaler Cellular

In an interview, Zscaler SVP of Innovation Nathan Howe pitched Zscaler Cellular, which extends zero trust to SIM-connected devices such as ATMs, EV chargers and pipelines. He highlighted per-packet inspection, geo-boundaries, deception and multi-carrier failover, and linked it to recent attacks on freezer and OT systems. Why it matters to F5: Zscaler is reaching further into OT and IoT edge security, which bears on F5's service provider and edge use cases. Product and alliance teams should watch it alongside F5's mobile-network security positioning.

https://blog.tmcnet.com/blog/rich-tehrani/security/zscalers-nathan-howe-on-the-freezer-attacks-and-why-ot-needs-zero-trust-everywhere.html

Product Launch Check Point Software 2026-11-06

Check Point Launches Firewall-as-a-Subscription in Japan

Check Point Japan launched Firewall-as-a-Subscription. It bundles Quantum Force hardware, the AI Network Firewall (R82.20) for inspecting AI traffic and controlling agents, SandBlast threat prevention, Smart-1 cloud agentic management, 24/7 support and professional-services credits. Terms are three years, billed monthly or annually, with no upfront hardware cost and a hardware refresh in year 3. Why it matters to F5: OPEX-style subscription bundles that include AI security put pressure on F5's own hardware and subscription pricing. Sellers should be ready to compare F5 Flex and consumption models. The global announcement came October 26; this is the Japan launch.

https://prtimes.jp/main/html/rd/p/000000568.000021207.html

Product Update Check Point Software 2026-11-06

Check Point Positions Email Security Unified Quarantine Against Proofpoint and Microsoft ICES

A Check Point blog compares its Email Security Unified Quarantine with Proofpoint's integration into Microsoft Defender ICES. Check Point stresses independent, policy-based remediation and automatic restoration of messages when its verdict differs from Microsoft's. Why it matters to F5: email is not an F5 market, but this shows Check Point using Workspace Security to land platform deals. It is useful context for PMM narratives about Check Point's four-pillar consolidation pitch.

https://blog.checkpoint.com/email-security/beyond-unified-detection-what-email-security-teams-need-to-control/

Product Update Cloudflare 2026-11-06

Cloudflare Access Adds Passkey Sign-In; Cloudflare One UEBA Adds Fast Flux Detection

Cloudflare Access now supports passkeys (device, security key or password manager) for protected apps and the App Launcher, replacing one-time PINs or an external identity provider. Separately, Cloudflare One UEBA added fast-flux DNS detection as a predefined risk behavior that feeds user risk scores on Enterprise plans. Why it matters to F5: Cloudflare keeps adding steady zero trust and SASE features to its platform. F5 teams positioning Distributed Cloud and BIG-IP APM for app access should be ready for comparisons on passwordless and risk-based access.

https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-11-06-access-passkeys/

Research Cloudflare 2026-11-06

Cloudflare Research Introduces MOLE Blind Signatures for Post-Quantum Private Web Authentication

A Cloudflare blog post sets out a path to post-quantum privacy for anti-abuse tokens such as Privacy Pass, which rely on classical cryptography. It introduces MOLE, a blind-signature technique meant to keep authentication unlinkable after Q-day. Why it matters to F5: Cloudflare is building thought leadership on post-quantum cryptography and privacy-preserving bot mitigation. F5 PMM should keep F5's own PQC roadmap story for BIG-IP and Distributed Cloud current.

https://blog.cloudflare.com/vole-mole/

Product Update Cloudflare 2026-11-06

Cloudflare AI Gateway Adds Provider Key Activity Monitoring and Key Security Review

Cloudflare AI Gateway now shows usage activity for stored LLM provider keys: masked previews, aliases, and last-used and last-updated dates. A new Key Security section flags keys unused for more than 90 days so they can be rotated or removed. Why it matters to F5: AI gateway credential hygiene is a growing governance requirement. F5 product and PMM should check that F5 AI Gateway offers equivalent secrets and key-lifecycle visibility for AI traffic.

https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-11-06-provider-key-security/

Event Cloudflare 2026-11-06

Cloudflare CEO Calls AI Agents a 'Bane' for Site Operators, Pitches Protection and Monetization

CEO Matthew Prince said AI agents may generate up to 1,000x more traffic than human clicks, which wastes origin resources and worries site operators. He positioned Cloudflare to block, manage or monetize agent traffic, and cited Q3 revenue of $782.5M. Why it matters to F5: Cloudflare is turning agentic bot traffic into a security and revenue story. F5 sellers should bring F5 Distributed Cloud Bot Defense and AI-agent traffic controls to publishers and e-commerce customers facing agent load.

https://www.theregister.com/networks/2026/11/06/ai-agents-are-a-bane-for-some-website-operators-says-cloudflare/5308022

Product Update AWS 2026-11-06

AWS Security Hub Adds SBOM Inventory for EC2, ECR and Lambda

Security Hub now automatically builds a software bill of materials inventory from Amazon Inspector data for EC2 instances, ECR images and Lambda functions. Packages can be filtered, grouped and queried through the API. It is included at no extra cost with Security Hub Essentials in all regions. Why it matters to F5: AWS keeps expanding free, native security posture tooling. That raises the bar for third-party value on AWS, so F5 alliance and PMM teams should stress multicloud consistency and inline app protection that AWS-native tools don't provide.

https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/11/security-hub-sbom-inventory/

Product Launch AWS 2026-11-06

SageMaker Inference Adds NVIDIA Multi-Instance GPU (MIG) Support for Model Endpoints

SageMaker AI endpoints can now split a single NVIDIA GPU into isolated MIG instances, each with its own compute and memory. This gives predictable latency, tenant isolation and more models per GPU without running Kubernetes. Why it matters to F5: AWS is improving GPU utilization for managed inference, which overlaps with F5's AI data delivery and GPU traffic-optimization story. Alliance and PMM teams should frame F5 as the traffic and security layer across multicloud and on-prem GPU fleets.

https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/machine-learning/sagemaker-inference-now-supports-multi-instance-gpu-to-maximize-gpu-utilization-for-model-endpoints/

Product Update AWS 2026-11-06

Kimi K3.1 Pro (Highspeed) Now Available on Amazon Bedrock

Moonshot AI's Kimi K3.1 Pro (Highspeed) is now on Bedrock. It is an open-weight, multimodal agentic model with a 1M-token context window, offered with prompt caching and cross-Region inference in all Bedrock regions. Why it matters to F5: Bedrock's model catalog keeps growing, which makes multi-model routing and governance harder for customers. That is an opening for F5 AI Gateway and AI Guardrails as a model-agnostic control point.

https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/11/moonshot-ai-kimi-k3-1-pro-on-amazon-bedrock/

Product Update AWS 2026-11-06

AWS Details Secure Remote Claude Code on Bedrock AgentCore with Guardrails Prompt Screening

An AWS guide shows Claude Code running as a remote AgentCore agent. Each task runs in an isolated microVM, uses short-lived GitHub tokens through AgentCore Identity and stays inside private VPC endpoints. Prompts are screened by Bedrock Guardrails for jailbreaks, prompt injection and leaked secrets. Why it matters to F5: AWS is putting agentic AI security (identity, isolation, guardrails) inside Bedrock. F5 should position AI Guardrails and AI Red Team as cross-cloud, model-agnostic options.

https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/machine-learning/extend-claude-code-to-remote-sessions-on-amazon-bedrock-agentcore-with-security-controls/

Product Update AWS 2026-11-06

AWS Agent Registry (Bedrock AgentCore) Generally Available in AWS GovCloud (US-West)

AWS Agent Registry is now available in GovCloud (US-West). It is a governed catalog of MCP servers, tools and agents with approval workflows and CloudTrail audit logs. Why it matters to F5: AWS is bringing governance of agents and MCP servers to public-sector customers. Federal sellers and alliance teams should position F5's MCP and agent traffic security as complementary, especially in hybrid federal environments.

https://www.daily-aws.com/headlines/20261106/

Leadership Fastly 2026-11-06

Fastly Appoints Calise Goh as Director of JAPAC Field Marketing

Fastly named Calise Goh Director of JAPAC Field Marketing. She will run regional campaigns, events, digital programs and partner marketing across Japan and Asia-Pacific, tied to sales priorities. The hire comes right after Fastly's strong Q3, when security revenue grew 32%. Why it matters to F5: Fastly is spending more on go-to-market in APJ. F5 marketing and field teams there should expect more Fastly demand generation and partner activity around edge delivery, bot management and AI security.

https://itbusinesstoday.com/martech/marketing/calise-goh-joins-fastly-as-director-of-japac-field-marketing/

Security Advisory Citrix (NetScaler) 2026-11-06

Metasploit Adds Public Unauthenticated RCE Exploit for Citrix NetScaler (CVE-2026-88771)

Rapid7's November 6 Metasploit release adds a ready-made exploit module for CVE-2026-88771. The flaw is an unauthenticated command-injection bug in NetScaler ADC and Gateway that gives root code execution, and it was exploited in the wild before disclosure. A public exploit means any attacker can now go after unpatched gateways, not just skilled ones. This adds to the run of NetScaler zero-days since October. Why it matters to F5: NetScaler customers face more urgent patching and threat-hunting work. That opens conversations about BIG-IP migration and services engagements.

https://www.rapid7.com/blog/post/pt-metasploit-wrapup-unauth-rce-modules-in-network-perimeter-devices-and-much-more/

Financial Arista Networks 2026-11-06

Arista CEO: 10+ GW of AI Deployments by 2027, but No Material Scale-Up Ethernet Revenue Until 2028

Earnings coverage published November 6 quotes CEO Jayshree Ullal. She expects more than 10 GW of AI deployments by the end of 2027, mostly in scale-out and scale-across Ethernet fabrics. Trials of ESUN, Arista's Ethernet scale-up interconnect, start in 2027, with production in 2028. Arista guides 2027 revenue to about $18.5B and expects AI fabrics revenue to double to about $7B. Why it matters to F5: AI factory networks are growing fast and spanning many sites. F5 can position BIG-IP Next for Kubernetes and AI traffic management alongside these fabrics.

https://www.techtimes.com/articles/330161/20261106/arista-q3-earnings-beat-estimates-ceo-sees-no-material-scale-ethernet-revenue-next-year.htm